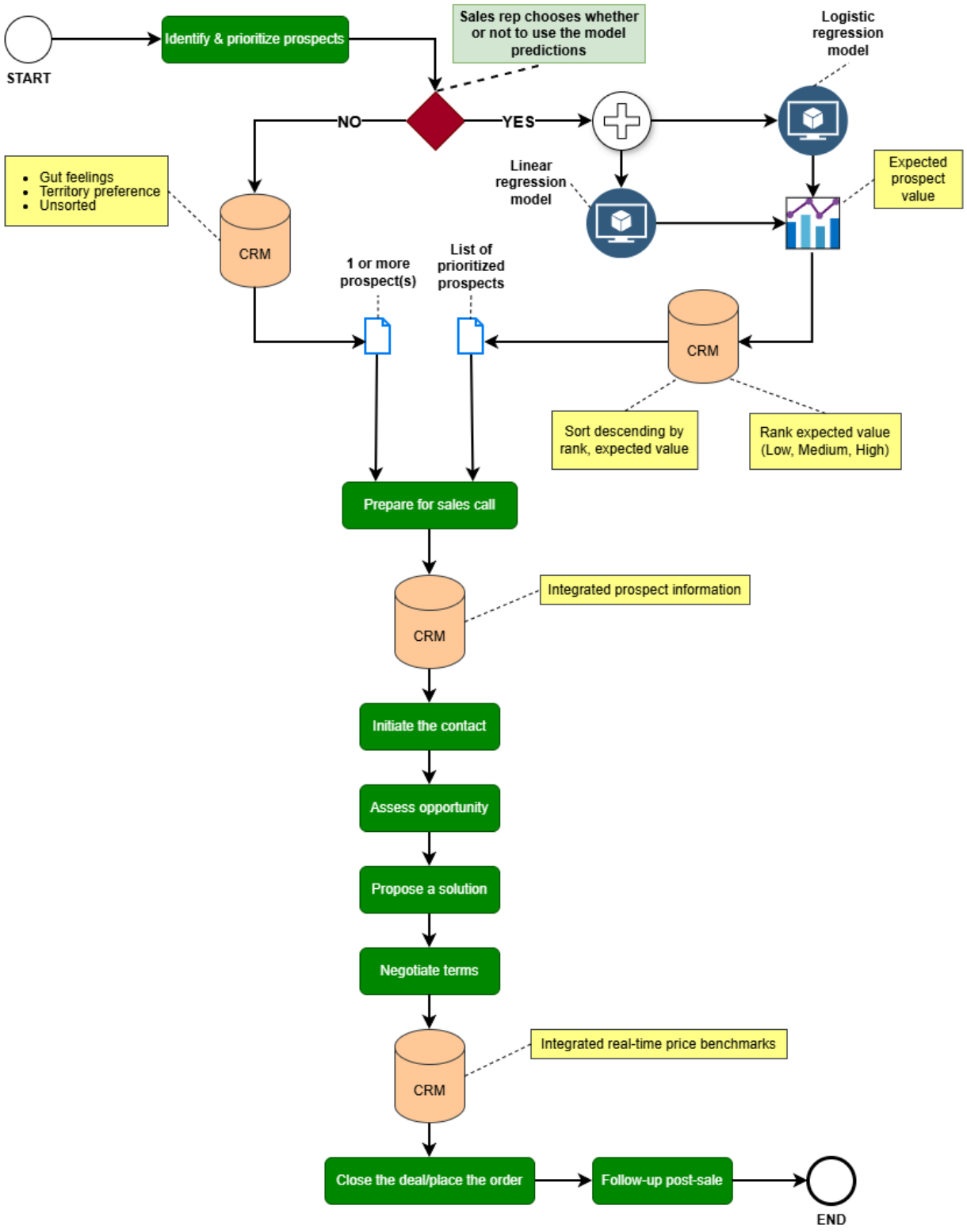
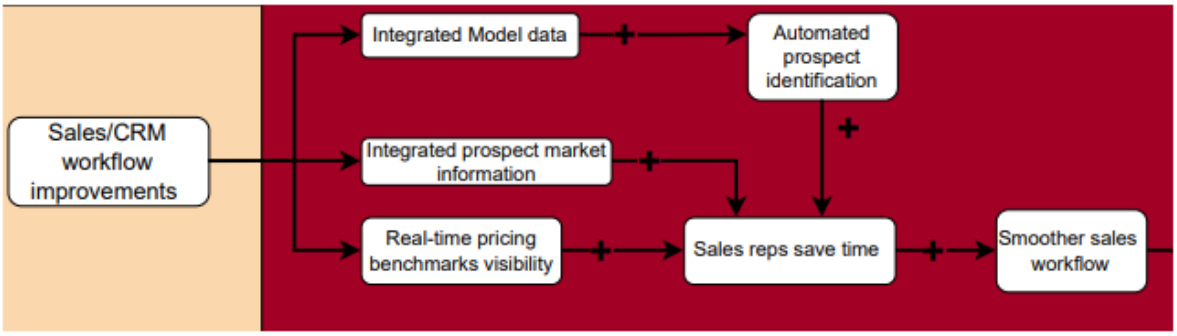
A. OwlGaze Sales Process Improvements

Proposed Sales Process



B. Key Relationships and Design Factors

CRM and sales process improvements



The causal decision diagram (CDD) (Appendix A) identified technical workflow improvements as a key lever driving sales rep adoption. Enhancing the sales process to accommodate the intermediates (integrated model predictions, market information, and benchmark pricing data) eliminates known bottlenecks and inefficiencies in the current process.

Automated expected value rankings are presented alongside the manual prospect prioritization workflow, driven by gut feelings and territory preferences. Unified Prospect market information eliminates the excessive time spent searching for prospect-related information. Integrated real-time pricing benchmarks reduce delays in negotiation. Each of these enhancements creates a smoother sales workflow, resulting in higher adoption rates among sales representatives.

Sales Rep Choice: Use the Models or Not?

The decision of sales representatives to use or not use the models occurs at the beginning of the process, at Step 1 (Identify & Prioritize Prospects), and is represented by the red diamond. This choice diverges into two paths: “Yes” or “No”.

The "No" path (not using the model predictions) mirrors the current sales process. The result is a list of one or more prospects.

The Yes path (use the model predictions) gathers data from both models and multiplies their outputs, yielding the expected value for each prospect. The prediction data is integrated into HorizonCRM for ranking and sorting, allowing for the creation of a prioritized list of prospects available to the sales representative.

Both paths converge again on Step 2 (Prepare for sales call).

Step 3 (Initiate the contact) through the end of the process is the same for both paths. Two CRM improvements, integrated prospect information and real-time price benchmarks, are available to sales reps regardless of whether they initially choose to use the models or not.

C. Key Strategies

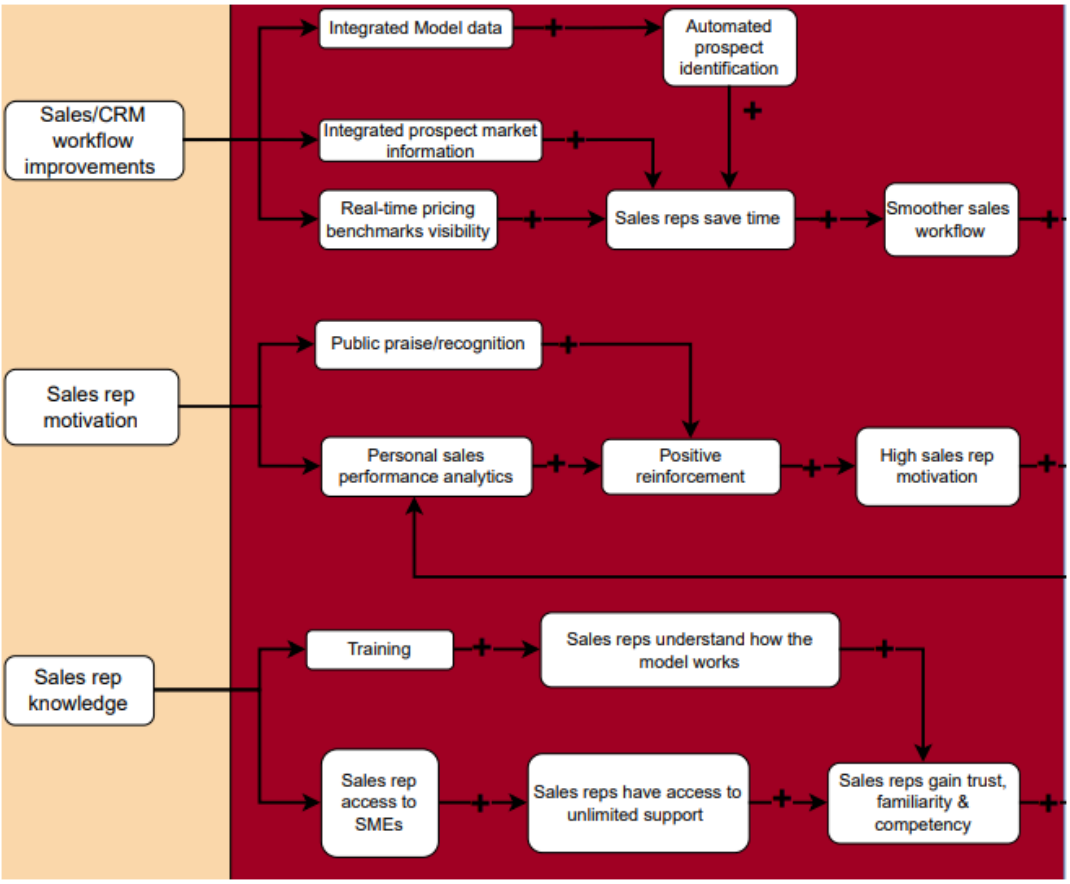
Two key strategies that OwlGaze should prioritize are CRM workflow improvements and enhancing sales reps' knowledge through training.

CRM workflow improvements focus on seamlessly integrating model outputs into Horizon CRM and alleviating pain points in the current workflow. The sales workflow has manual elements that are time-consuming. To reduce sales representative resistance, the workflow should be usable and require less work for the representatives (Pratt & Malcom, 2023). The smoother and less time-intensive the workflow, the more likely sales reps will choose it, leading to increased adoption.

The sales rep training strategy addresses apprehension and/or aversion to adopting the models. Training should include educating sales reps on experiment results, model functionality, model outputs, and expected value calculations. Building competency and familiarity with the models fosters confidence and trust in the improved workflow, thereby reducing sales representative resistance and increasing adoption.

D. Human-Centered Design

Based on the CDD, all decision levers lead to increased adoption, which in turn leads to increased sales revenue for each representative, highlighting the critical importance of persuading sales representatives to adopt the model process for strategic success voluntarily. As a result, the adoption strategy is centered around sales rep behavior and motivations, incorporating Pratt and Malcom's human-centered design principles throughout (Pratt & Malcom, 2023).



The first lever, CRM and sales workflow improvements, incorporates non-disruptive integration and accessibility principles by integrating model data, prospect market information, and real-time pricing benchmarks within the existing HorizonCRM interface, ensuring reps can access enhanced functionality without learning new systems or disrupting their established workflows. Process improvements enable voluntary choice in model usage, reflecting the principle of user autonomy.

The Sales Rep Knowledge lever applies the feedback & support principle through comprehensive training programs and unlimited SME access, building the understanding and competency needed for reps to gain trust in model outputs and feel confident using the new tools.

The Sales Rep Motivation lever demonstrates the incorporation of trust-building and transparency principles through positive reinforcement, including personal performance analytics and public recognition, which encourages adoption by demonstrating value to sales reps rather than through mandates.

E. Implementation Steps

- **Phase 1: (Sales/CRM workflow improvements)**

Step 1 (IT follow-up item): Integrate model-based prospect scoring by developing API connections between the logistic and linear regression models and HorizonCRM to calculate and display expected value rankings automatically.

Step 2 (IT follow-up item): Integrate external market information and real-time pricing benchmarks into HorizonCRM by establishing automated data feeds that populate market intelligence and benchmark pricing during prospect preparation and negotiation phases.

- **Phase 2: Training Plans (Sales rep knowledge)**

Step 1 (SMEs): Develop engaging training and reference materials covering the model experiment results, expected value calculation, and integrated HorizonCRM features. Deliver training in multiple formats to smaller groups of sales reps.

Step 2 (SMEs): Establish open office hours where sales reps can freely ask any questions about the model and receive one-on-one support, supplemented by an FAQ site. Rotate in new SMEs throughout the initiative to ensure continuous coverage.

- **Phase 3: Motivation Plans (Sales rep motivation)**

Step 1 (Sales Leadership): Determine the cadence and triggers for celebrating progress toward adoption and increased sales revenue per representative. Praise publicly and often.

Step 2: (Analytics): Establish personalized performance dashboards for sales reps accessible within HorizonCRM, displaying current performance versus performance from the previous sales quarter.

F. Continuous Monitoring

1. Model performance (Analytics): Conduct monthly model performance reviews for model accuracy and fit to prevent model drift.

2. Sales rep adherence: Monitor weekly adoption rates and track the percentage of prospects prioritized using the model.

G. Key performance indicators

KPI 1: Logistic Model Accuracy
Model accuracy measures how well the logistic model's predicted customer purchase probabilities align with actual customer purchases. Retrain the model if accuracy drops more than 10% below the baseline of 86.5% **(<77.85%)**.

KPI 2: Logistic Model Reliability
Model reliability measures the model's ability to consistently identify prospects accurately. Retrain if the F1 Score drops more than 10% below the baseline of 0.815 **(<0.734)**.

KPI 3: Linear Model Stability

Model stability represents the degree of errors in the linear model's deal size predictions. Retrain the model if the root mean error exceeds the baseline of 11.8% by more than 10% **(> 12.98%)**.

KPI 4: Linear Model Relevance
Model relevance indicates how well the model accurately captures the actual trend of deal sizes in real-world scenarios. Retrain if the adjusted R-squared value drops more than 10% below the baseline of 0.80 **(< 0.72)**.

H. Continuous Improvement

1. Iterative Process Improvements
OwlGaze should continue to refine the sales workflow to ensure sustained high adoption rates and address process issues deemed out of scope for the decision team's strategy.

- **Sales rep feedback loop**: Establish a recurring "Pain Point Review" meeting. Since several bottlenecks identified during the pilot were outside the scope of this initial model, this review provides sales reps with a formal channel to request workflow changes.

- **Out-of-scope bottlenecks**: This strategy did not initially address the manual proposal process involving product specialists, which appears to be a significant source of delay in the sales process. Prioritize addressing this issue in order to maximize adoption.

- **Deprecation of legacy manual processes**: When target adoption reaches 100%, **or** if adoption remains above 90% for three consecutive months, begin plans to officially deprecate the manual process.

2. Iterative model improvements

- **Automated Correction Triggers**: Retraining is triggered automatically if any primary KPI (Accuracy, Reliability, Stability, Relevance) drops by more than 10%. These triggers will prevent model drift, where the models continue to predict based on outdated market data.

- **Scheduled Model Refresh**: Even if performance remains stable, OwlGaze should periodically fully refresh the models to ensure the recency and timeliness of the underlying training data.

- **Error Analysis**: When model retraining is triggered, review all errors to determine if the models would benefit from new data points.

References

Pratt, L. Y., & Malcolm, N. E. (2023). *The Decision Intelligence Handbook*. O'Reilly Media.